

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/8: 1. Six survival terms

SOUL = alleged enduring subject | PERSONAL IDENTITY = what makes later person same

IMMORTALITY = survival of death | REBIRTH = new embodied existence

RESURRECTION = divine restoration of embodied person | LIBERATION = release from bondage

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QUESTIONS MUST BE KEPT DISTINCT

what survives? -> by what continuity criterion? -> where/when? -> through whose agency?

-> is survival endless life, renewed embodiment, or freedom from rebirth?

TERM CONTROL prevents treating Plato, Buddhism, Vedānta and Christianity as one doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/8: 2. Western immortality arguments

PLATO

cyclical argument: opposites arise from opposites

recollection: a priori knowledge suggests prenatal existence

affinity: invisible rational soul resembles unchanging Forms

Phaedo final argument: soul essentially bears life and cannot admit death

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objections: pre-existence != endless survival; harmony analogy; dependence on brain

DESIRE/JUSTICE ARGUMENTS: fulfilment or moral completion suggests afterlife

limit: wish and moral need do not by themselves establish metaphysical survival.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/8: 3. Personal identity after death

IDENTITY CANDIDATES

- +-> same immaterial substance
- +-> bodily continuity / resurrection
- +-> memory and psychological continuity (Locke)
- +-> causal narrative continuity

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REID: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem

duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons

resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production

verdict depends on whether identity needs strict sameness or survival-grade continuity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/8: 4. Karma, rebirth and Buddhist continuity

INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṃskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṃsāra

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BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN

five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant

flame-to-flame: neither numerically identical nor wholly unrelated

intention conditions later fruit; memory is causally produced cognition

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objection: who receives karma? reply: demand for substance mistakes continuity for identity

nirvāṇa ends craving and the causal appropriation that renews birth.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/8: 5. Liberation parity bench

SCHOOL	BONDAGE	LIBERATION
Advaita	avidyā, false identity	jñāna: ātman = Brahman
Viśiṣṭādvaita	karma, dependence obscured	bhakti/prapatti; communion
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	puruṣa-prakṛti confusion	kaivalya through viveka
Nyāya	false knowledge, doṣa, karma	apavarga: cessation of pain
Jainism	karmic pudgala on jīva	kevala-jñāna, siddhahood
Buddhism	craving/ignorance	nirvāṇa
Christianity	sin/death	resurrection and salvation
SAME WORD “release” conceals different selves, causes, methods and end-states.		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/8: 6. Vedānta and Jain routes

ADVAITA: subtle body carries karma until knowledge; jīvanmukti possible;

videhamukti ends embodiment, not the ātman's existence

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: jīva remains real and distinct; grace, bhakti and prapatti lead to God

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JAINISM: jīva + passions/activity -> āsrava -> bandha

saṃvara blocks influx -> nirjarā sheds karma -> kevala-jñāna -> mokṣa

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contrast: Advaita removes ignorance of identity; Rāmānuja perfects dependence;

Jainism purges material karma from an eternally individual soul.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/8: 7. Paths, objections and ethical meaning

THREE BROAD MEANS: jñāna (knowledge) | bhakti (devotion) | karma (disciplined action)

Yoga adds meditative discipline; Jainism adds vows/austerity; Buddhism eightfold path

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objections: disembodied soul lacks individuation | rebirth lacks memory

liberation as painlessness seems empty | endless survival may be burden, not good

replies: character/causal continuity can outlast episodic memory;

liberation is evaluated by freedom from ignorance, craving or sin, not mere duration

ethical test: doctrine should transform present conduct, not postpone justice to another life.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/8: 8. PYQ answer rail

DEFINE exact survival term → identify bearer and continuity criterion

- > explain causal mechanism -> state soteriological end and path
- > strongest objection (identity, evidence, justice) -> strongest reply
- > compare one unlike doctrine on same axes -> qualified conclusion

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ANSWER AXES: self/no-self | body/disembodiment | karma/grace | continuity/identity
| endless existence/release from existence

CLOSE: survival doctrines are credible only when their ontology of the person,
continuity mechanism and ethical-liberative purpose support one another.